







(Clockwise from above) A still from S.S. Rajamouli's *RRR*, which not only did well globally but the song 'Naatu Naatu' from the film bagged the Oscar for Best Original Song in 2023; *Munjya* is among the films that left an impact on audiences this year; a still from *Kill*, the first Hindi film to get a broad theatrical release in the US and Kartiki Gonsalves's *The Elephant Whisperers*, which won the Oscar for Best Documentary Short last year

has played a crucial role in supporting and funding Indian documentaries, as seen with *The Elephant Whisperers* and *Period. End of Sentence*. As someone deeply involved in the documentary field, I am currently working on *Kicking Balls*, a film about child marriage in Rajasthan, directed by Vijeyata Kumar and co-produced with Ashvini Yardi. The film revolves around young brides using football to challenge traditional practices. The growing appetite for realistic and impactful content in India indicates that documentaries have a promising future.

Our audience is ready for diverse formats and genres. This is a time for bold, innovative filmmaking. And from what I've seen, in the incredible work my peers, companions, and competitors have been up to, we've got a whole lot more to offer. As I stated in my speech after the Oscar win for *The Elephant Whisperers* in 2023, "The future is audacious, the future is us, and the future is here. Jai Hind!" ■

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